

BRAND GUIDELINES

NOIR ESPRESSO

Brand Identity & Tone of Voice Manual — Version 2.1

Brand:	Noir Espresso Co.	Version:	2.1 (March 2024)
Category:	Luxury Coffee & Café Experiences	Status:	Active / Approved
Markets:	UAE, KSA, Qatar, Egypt, UK	Approved by:	Brand Director



Brand Foundation

Brand Mission

To make every cup of coffee a deliberate act of pleasure. Noir Espresso exists for people who believe that how you start your day shapes everything that follows — and who refuse to settle for less than exceptional.

Brand Vision

To be the defining luxury coffee brand of the Arab world by 2030 — a name synonymous with craft, ritual, and quiet confidence.

Brand Values

Craft above all:	Every product decision — from single-origin sourcing to espresso extraction time — is made in service of quality. We never compromise on the product.
Quiet luxury:	Noir is not loud. Our confidence comes from substance, not spectacle. We let the quality speak.
Ritual & intention:	We believe in the power of deliberate moments. A Noir coffee is not consumed — it is experienced.
Insider knowledge:	We treat our customers as connoisseurs, not consumers. We share knowledge, explain process, and elevate understanding.
Arabic roots, global standards:	We are proud of our Middle Eastern heritage. We blend regional identity with international excellence.

Brand Identity

Color Palette

Color Name	HEX	RGB	CMYK	Usage
Espresso Black	#1A0A00	26, 10, 0	0, 62, 100, 90	Primary brand color
Gold Leaf	#C9A84C	201, 168, 76	0, 16, 62, 21	Premium accents
Cream Parchment	#FDF6E3	253, 246, 227	0, 3, 10, 1	Backgrounds
Charcoal Mist	#4A4A4A	74, 74, 74	0, 0, 0, 71	Body text
Warm White	#FAFAF8	250, 250, 248	0, 0, 1, 2	Digital backgrounds

Typography

Role	Typeface	Weight	Usage
Primary Display	Playfair Display	Bold / ExtraBold	Headlines, logo wordmark
Secondary Sans	Inter	Regular / Medium	Body copy, UI, captions
Accent Script	Cormorant Garamond	Italic	Pull quotes, special callouts
Digital Fallback	Georgia	Regular	Email, web fallback only

Tone of Voice

Noir's tone of voice is the single most important brand consistency factor across all channels. Every piece of copy — from a 3-word Instagram caption to a 500-word blog post — must feel like it was written by the same person: someone who knows coffee deeply, respects their audience completely, and never tries too hard.

The Four Tone Pillars

Refined, not pretentious:	We use precise language without being exclusive. We never make customers feel like they don't know enough. Avoid: 'only the truly discerning...' or 'unlike ordinary coffee...'
Warm, not casual:	We are welcoming and human, but we maintain dignity. No slang, no exclamation marks used for emphasis. Avoid: 'Hey guys!', 'OMG this is SO GOOD!', 'Check this out!'
Confident, not arrogant:	We state our quality as fact, not boast. We never compare or attack competitors. Avoid: 'The best coffee in Dubai' (unverifiable claim), 'Unlike other coffee brands...'
Poetic, not purple:	We use evocative, sensory language — but sparingly. One strong metaphor per piece of writing. No purple prose or forced lyricism. Avoid: stacking three metaphors in one sentence.

Tone in Practice — Do's and Don'ts

Situation	OFF-BRAND (Do Not Use)	ON-BRAND (Use This)
Instagram product caption	'OMG our new blend just dropped! You NEED to try this game-changer! ☕️🔥'	'Our new Geisha Reserve is in. A few bags. No rush.'
Morning coffee post	'Start your day RIGHT with the BEST coffee in town! ☀️☕️'	'Some mornings need no words. Just this.'
Limited edition announcement	'HURRY! LIMITED STOCK! Don't miss out!!! 🚨🔥'	'The Geisha Reserve. Twelve kilograms. If you know, you know.'
Responding to a negative review	'I'm sorry for any inconvenience caused! We hope you'll give us another chance! 😊'	'That's not the experience we work for. Please reach us at hello@noir.coffee'
Describing a new product	'This coffee is super smooth and tasty with amazing flavors! 🍌🍌🍌'	'Soft fruit at the front. A long, clean finish. Best extracted at 93°C.'
Promoting a sale / offer	'MASSIVE SALE — 30% OFF EVERYTHING! BUY NOW! 🎉🎉🎉'	'For this week: 30% off the Reserve Collection. A quieter way to discover.'

What We Never Say

- Any superlative without proof: 'best', 'number one', 'world's finest', 'unmatched'
- Generic filler phrases: 'quality you can trust', 'passion for coffee', 'crafted with love'
- Urgency manipulation: 'limited time only', 'don't miss out', 'selling fast', 'act now'
- Excessive punctuation or emoji use: multiple exclamation marks, fire emoji for emphasis, '!!!!'
- Casual internet language: 'vibe', 'lowkey', 'hits different', 'ngl', 'slay', 'no cap'
- Direct competitor mentions: never name or allude to competitors in any copy

- Health or wellness claims: we sell pleasure, not medicine — never imply health benefits

Channel-Specific Guidelines

Channel	Max Word Count	Emoji Policy	Hashtag Limit	Key Tone Note
Instagram Caption	120 words max	Max 2, only classic (🍷🍷)	Max 8, curated only	Poetic, sparse
Instagram Story	15 words max	Max 1	None	Direct, confident
LinkedIn	200 words max	None	Max 3	Professional, insightful
Email Subject Line	8 words max	None	N/A	Intriguing, never clickbait
Email Body	300 words max	None	N/A	Warm but concise
Website Product Copy	80 words max	None	N/A	Sensory, precise
SMS / WhatsApp	20 words max	Max 1	None	Exclusive, personal

CONFIDENTIAL — Internal Brand Document. For agency and approved partner use only. Not for distribution.